

CoreAxis Technologies

Finance Department Handbook

Official policies, procedures, and standards governing all financial operations of CoreAxis Technologies — for internal use by Finance Department personnel.

Section 1

Welcome to the Finance Department

Welcome to the Finance Department of CoreAxis Technologies. As a member of this team, you serve a critical function in the organisation — ensuring that every rupee the company spends, earns, and accounts for is managed with precision, discipline, and integrity.

CoreAxis Technologies is an AI software company headquartered in Chennai, Tamil Nadu, with a branch office in Bengaluru, Karnataka. We develop AI-powered enterprise software, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) systems, Large Language Model (LLM) applications, cloud-native platforms, intelligent automation solutions, computer vision applications, and data analytics products. Our Finance Department supports the operational and strategic financial needs of a fast-moving, technology-driven organisation.

This handbook is your primary reference document. It covers the policies, procedures, approval workflows, and operating standards that govern all financial activities at CoreAxis Technologies. It is written for Finance Managers, Accountants, Financial Analysts, Payroll Specialists, Procurement Officers, and Accounts Payable and Receivable Executives.

Every policy in this handbook is binding. Departures from documented procedures must be approved in writing by the Finance Manager or a senior authority. Repeated non-compliance is subject to disciplinary action.

Document Status

This handbook is a controlled internal document. It is reviewed annually and updated as required when regulatory changes, operational needs, or management decisions require revision. The most current version is maintained in Confluence under the Finance Department workspace. Printed copies are for reference only — always verify currency against the master document.

If you have questions about any policy in this document, contact the Finance Manager. If you identify a gap or believe a procedure is missing, raise it formally via your reporting manager.

Welcome to the team. The Finance Department's work is the backbone of CoreAxis Technologies' operational reliability. We hold ourselves to the highest standards of accuracy and accountability.

Section 2

Department Overview

The Finance Department at CoreAxis Technologies is responsible for all financial operations, controls, compliance activities, and reporting obligations of the company. The department operates out of the Chennai head office and provides financial support to both the Chennai and Bengaluru locations.

Core Responsibilities

- Financial planning, budgeting, and forecasting
- Accounts payable and receivable management
- Payroll processing and statutory compliance
- Procurement support and vendor management
- Financial reporting and management information systems
- Tax compliance — Income Tax, GST, TDS, and professional tax
- Internal controls and audit readiness
- Cash and treasury management
- Asset accounting and depreciation management
- Cloud infrastructure and software cost governance

Approved Systems

CoreAxis Technologies maintains a suite of approved financial and operational systems. All financial data must be recorded in approved systems only. Use of personal spreadsheets, personal email, or unapproved tools for processing financial transactions is prohibited.

System	Primary Use
Zoho Books	Primary accounting and bookkeeping
TallyPrime	GST returns and statutory filings
Microsoft Dynamics 365	ERP and financial reporting

Oracle NetSuite	Advanced financial management (as adopted)
SAP Business One	Procurement and inventory (reference integration)
Microsoft Excel	Internal analysis, reconciliations, planning models
Power BI	Financial dashboards and management reporting
AWS Billing Console	Cloud cost monitoring (AWS)
Azure Cost Management	Cloud cost monitoring (Azure)
GitHub Enterprise	Software licence and subscription tracking
Jira	Procurement and finance workflow ticketing
Confluence	Policy documentation and SOPs
Microsoft Teams	Internal communication and approval records
Google Workspace	Document collaboration and external communication

Working Hours and Location

The Finance Department operates Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM IST. CoreAxis Technologies follows a hybrid working model. Finance team members handling time-sensitive tasks — such as payroll processing, bank reconciliation, and statutory filing deadlines — are expected to be present in office during critical processing windows. Remote work arrangements must be approved by

the Finance Manager and must not compromise access to financial systems or approval workflows.

System Access Policy

Access to financial systems is granted on a need-to-access basis and is role-specific.

Credentials must never be shared. Access revocation requests must be submitted to the Finance Manager and IT within 24 hours of a team member's resignation, transfer, or role change.

Section 3

Finance Team Structure

The Finance Department is structured to support segregation of duties, operational efficiency, and clear lines of accountability. The following roles constitute the department. Actual headcount per role may vary based on business requirements.

Finance Manager

The Finance Manager is the head of the department and reports directly to the Chief Executive Officer or Chief Financial Officer. The Finance Manager holds overall accountability for the financial integrity, compliance, and reporting obligations of CoreAxis Technologies.

Key Responsibilities

- Oversee all financial operations, controls, and compliance activities
- Lead annual budgeting, quarterly forecasting, and long-range financial planning

- Review and approve financial statements, tax filings, and audit reports
- Authorise payments above defined thresholds and sign banking instruments
- Manage relationships with external auditors, banks, and regulatory bodies
- Approve vendor onboarding, contracts above ₹5,00,000, and CAPEX requests
- Ensure compliance with the Companies Act, Income Tax Act, GST Act, and all applicable labour laws
- Sign off on monthly closing procedures and management reports

Accountant

The Accountant manages the day-to-day bookkeeping and accounting operations of the company, ensuring all transactions are recorded accurately, completely, and on time.

Key Responsibilities

- Maintain the general ledger and chart of accounts in Zoho Books and TallyPrime
- Process all journal entries, including accruals and provisions
- Perform monthly bank reconciliations
- Prepare monthly trial balances and assist in financial statement preparation
- Manage fixed asset register and depreciation schedules
- Coordinate with external auditors during audit periods
- Support TDS filing, GST reconciliation, and statutory payment schedules

Financial Analyst

The Financial Analyst is responsible for analysing financial data, producing management reports, and providing decision-support information to the Finance Manager and senior leadership.

Key Responsibilities

- Prepare monthly, quarterly, and annual financial reports using Power BI and Excel
- Conduct budget-versus-actual analysis and variance reporting
- Model financial scenarios for project investments and business initiatives
- Monitor cloud infrastructure costs across AWS and Azure and produce cost optimisation reports
- Track software licence and SaaS subscription costs against approved budgets
- Support the annual budgeting process with data analysis and trend projections
- Produce AI project cost allocation reports for the AI and ML department

Payroll Specialist

The Payroll Specialist manages all aspects of employee compensation, statutory deductions, and payroll-related compliance.

Key Responsibilities

- Process monthly payroll for all employees across Chennai and Bengaluru
- Calculate and remit Provident Fund (PF), Employee State Insurance (ESI), and professional tax
- Manage TDS on salaries (Section 192) and issue Form 16 annually

- Administer employee leave encashment, gratuity calculations, and final settlements
- Maintain payroll records and payslip archives
- Coordinate with HR for salary revisions, new joiners, and separation processing

Procurement Officer

The Procurement Officer manages the sourcing, evaluation, and onboarding of vendors, and oversees the purchase request-to-order process.

Key Responsibilities

- Manage the end-to-end procurement process from purchase request to purchase order
- Source and evaluate vendors in compliance with the Vendor Selection Policy
- Maintain the approved vendor register
- Negotiate contracts and service agreements within approved parameters
- Track CAPEX and OPEX purchase orders against approved budgets
- Coordinate hardware and software asset procurement
- Manage cloud subscription renewals and SaaS licence procurement

Accounts Payable Executive

The Accounts Payable (AP) Executive manages all outgoing payments to vendors, service providers, and government authorities.

Key Responsibilities

- Receive, verify, and process vendor invoices against approved purchase orders

- Execute payments via NEFT, RTGS, or cheque per the payment schedule
- Manage the AP ageing report and ensure timely payment within agreed credit terms
- Reconcile vendor statements and resolve invoice disputes
- Process TDS deductions at source on applicable vendor payments
- Ensure all payments are recorded accurately in Zoho Books

Accounts Receivable Executive

The Accounts Receivable (AR) Executive manages all incoming payments from clients and ensures timely collection of revenue.

Key Responsibilities

- Generate and issue GST-compliant invoices to clients
- Monitor receivables ageing and initiate collection follow-ups
- Record client payments and reconcile against invoices
- Manage credit notes, debit notes, and adjustment entries
- Coordinate with project and sales teams on billing milestones
- Produce weekly receivables reports for the Finance Manager

Section 4

Financial Governance

Financial governance at CoreAxis Technologies is built on three pillars: a clear approval hierarchy, segregation of duties, and regular oversight. Every financial decision — from a small vendor payment to a large capital expenditure — must follow the governance framework defined in this section.

Approval Authority Matrix

The following matrix defines spending approval authority. Approvals must be documented in writing via Microsoft Teams, Jira, or email from an authorised approver's official CoreAxis email account. Verbal approvals are not accepted.

Transaction Type	Up to ₹25,000	Up to ₹1,00,000	Up to ₹5,00,000	Above ₹5,00,000
Operational Expenses (OPEX)	Department Head	Finance Manager	CFO / Director	Board Approval
Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)	Finance Manager	CFO / Director	Board Approval	Board Approval
Vendor Payments	AP Executive + Accountant	Finance Manager	Finance Manager + CFO	CFO + Director
Employee Reimbursements	Reporting Manager	Finance Manager	Finance Manager	Finance Manager + CFO
Software Subscriptions	Department Head	Finance Manager	CFO / Director	Board Approval
Cloud Infrastructure	Finance Manager	Finance Manager	CFO / Director	Board Approval
New Vendor Onboarding	Procurement Officer	Finance Manager	Finance Manager + CFO	Board Approval

Segregation of Duties

No single individual may initiate, approve, and record a financial transaction. The following segregation rules are mandatory and subject to internal audit review.

- The person raising a purchase request must not be the same person approving it
- The person approving an invoice for payment must not be the same person executing the bank transfer
- Payroll inputs must be prepared by the Payroll Specialist and reviewed by the Finance Manager before processing
- Bank reconciliations must be reviewed by the Finance Manager, not only by the Accountant who prepared them
- Vendor master data changes (banking details, addresses) must be approved by the Finance Manager and notified to the AP Executive separately from the party requesting the change

Audit Trail Requirements

All financial approvals, modifications, and reversals must leave a documented audit trail. System-generated logs in Zoho Books and Dynamics 365 satisfy this requirement. Manual approvals via Microsoft Teams or email must be archived in the Finance department's Google Drive folder under the appropriate period folder.

Conflict of Interest

Finance team members must immediately disclose any personal or familial relationship with a vendor, client, or counterparty to the Finance Manager before participating in any transaction involving that party. Disclosed conflicts are managed by reassigning the transaction to another team member.

Undisclosed conflicts discovered post-facto are subject to disciplinary action and may be referred to the Board.

Four-Eyes Principle

All payments above ₹1,00,000 require dual authorisation — the Finance Manager's approval and a Director's or CFO's countersignature. Banking portals must be configured to enforce two-factor payment release for all high-value transactions.

Section 5

Budget Planning Process

CoreAxis Technologies follows an annual budget cycle aligned to the Indian financial year (April 1 to March 31). The budgeting process is initiated in January each year and concluded by March 15, with the approved budget effective April 1.

Budget Categories

Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)

CAPEX covers investments in assets that provide economic benefit over more than one year. At CoreAxis Technologies, CAPEX items include:

- Workstations, laptops, and servers
- GPU hardware for AI model training and inference
- Networking infrastructure
- Office fit-out and leasehold improvements
- Proprietary software licences with multi-year terms

Operational Expenditure (OPEX)

OPEX covers recurring costs necessary to run the business. At CoreAxis Technologies, OPEX includes:

- Employee salaries, benefits, and statutory contributions
- Cloud infrastructure costs (AWS, Azure, GCP)
- SaaS subscription fees
- Office rent, utilities, and maintenance
- Professional services, consulting, and legal fees
- Third-party API usage charges (OpenAI, Google, etc.)
- Travel, training, and employee development
- Marketing and business development

Budget Submission Process

Annual Budget Preparation Timeline

January 10: Finance Manager distributes budget templates and guidelines to all department heads via email and Confluence

January 31: Department heads submit proposed budgets for their functions using the standard Excel template

February 5–15: Finance Manager reviews submissions, challenges assumptions, and conducts bilateral discussions with department heads

February 20: Consolidated draft budget presented to the CFO and/or Board for review

February 25: Revisions incorporated based on Board/CFO feedback

March 10: Final budget submitted for Board approval

March 15: Board-approved budget communicated to all departments

April 1: Approved budget becomes effective

Budget Templates and Instructions

The Finance Manager distributes a standard Excel workbook template each January. The template includes separate tabs for headcount costs, technology costs, cloud and infrastructure, travel and training, marketing, and general operating expenses. Department heads must populate all mandatory fields and provide a written justification for any line item that represents an increase of more than 15% over the prior year's actuals.

Note

The Technology and AI & ML departments are required to submit a separate cloud cost projection that includes estimated GPU hours, model training runs, and API usage volumes. This projection feeds into the cloud infrastructure budget and informs vendor negotiation with AWS and Azure.

Mid-Year Budget Revisions

Budget revisions may be requested at the Q2 review (September–October) if business conditions have materially changed. Revision requests must be submitted in writing by the department head, reviewed by the Finance Manager, and approved by the CFO. Ad-hoc budget revisions outside the Q2 window require exceptional approval from the CFO and Board.

Section 6

Annual Budget Approval

The annual budget approval process ensures that CoreAxis Technologies' expenditure plans are reviewed by appropriate authorities before any commitment is made to the market. The approval process is sequential and requires documented sign-off at each stage.

Approval Stages

Stage	Reviewer	Action Required	Deadline
Stage 1 — Department Submission	Each Department Head	Submit completed budget template	January 31
Stage 2 — Finance Review	Finance Manager	Review, challenge, and consolidate	February 15
Stage 3 — Executive Review	CFO / CEO	Review consolidated budget, approve or request revisions	February 22
Stage 4 — Board Presentation	Board of Directors	Final approval of the annual budget	March 10
Stage 5 — Communication	Finance Manager	Communicate approved budget to departments	March 15

Board Approval Requirements

The annual budget must be tabled as a formal agenda item at a Board of Directors meeting. The Finance Manager prepares the board presentation pack, which includes:

- Executive summary of total CAPEX and OPEX by category
- Headcount plan and associated salary cost
- Technology and cloud infrastructure budget
- Revenue projections and key financial assumptions
- Comparison of proposed budget against prior year actuals
- Identified risks and sensitivity analysis

Budget Freeze Period

During the period from March 1 to April 1, a budget freeze is in effect. No new purchase orders, vendor contracts, or significant OPEX commitments may be initiated until the Board has approved the upcoming year's budget. Exceptions require written approval from the CFO.

Budget Authority

An approved budget is an authorisation to spend up to the approved amount, within the approved category. It is not a guarantee or mandate to spend. Department heads are responsible for managing their budgets prudently and must notify the Finance Manager at the earliest opportunity if projected spending will deviate by more than 10% from the approved figure.

Quarterly Budget Reviews

The Finance Manager conducts formal quarterly budget reviews (Q1: July, Q2: October, Q3: January, Q4: April). Each review produces a budget-versus-actual report for each department, delivered via Power BI dashboards and a written management report. Department heads are required to provide written

explanations for variances above ₹50,000 per line item or 15% against the approved budget, whichever is lower.

Section 7

Department Budget Allocation

Once the annual budget is approved by the Board, the Finance Manager allocates budget to each department in Zoho Books and updates the cost centre structure in Dynamics 365. Each department head receives a formal budget allocation letter and has access to their departmental budget report in Power BI.

Cost Centres

CoreAxis Technologies organises financial reporting by cost centre. Each department has a unique cost centre code. All purchase orders, invoices, and expense claims must be coded to the correct cost centre at the time of entry.

Department	Cost Centre Code
Human Resources	CC-001
AI & Machine Learning	CC-002
Software Engineering	CC-003
Information Technology	CC-004
Finance	CC-005
Information Security	CC-006

Departmental Budget Responsibility

Department heads are budget holders for their cost centres. They are accountable for ensuring expenditure does not exceed the approved allocation without prior Finance approval. Budget holders must:

- Review their monthly budget-versus-actual report within five business days of receiving it
- Raise budget variance alerts to the Finance Manager if projected overspend is identified
- Obtain Finance Manager approval before committing any expenditure not included in the approved budget
- Ensure all team members are aware of their departmental budget limits before raising purchase requests

Inter-Department Budget Transfers

If a department requires budget to be transferred from one cost centre to another, the receiving and releasing department heads must both submit a written request to the Finance Manager. Transfers above ₹1,00,000 require CFO approval. All transfers are recorded as formal budget amendments in Zoho Books and reflected in subsequent Power BI dashboards.

Project-Specific Budgets

For client-facing projects and significant internal initiatives (e.g., a new AI product development programme), a project-specific budget code is created in Zoho Books. Project budget allocation follows the same approval process as departmental budgets. The Financial Analyst is responsible for tracking project

budget consumption monthly and reporting deviations to the Finance Manager and the relevant project manager.

Note

All cloud infrastructure costs (AWS, Azure) must be tagged at the project or cost centre level in the respective billing consoles. Untagged resources are flagged in the monthly cloud cost report. Persistent untagged resources after 30 days are subject to forced termination following notification to the department head.

Section 8

Procurement Policy

The Procurement Policy governs all purchasing activity at CoreAxis Technologies. It applies to every department and to all categories of expenditure — hardware, software, professional services, cloud subscriptions, and office supplies.

Core Procurement Principles

- **Value for Money:** All procurement decisions must represent the best available value, considering quality, price, service, and risk — not merely the lowest cost.
- **Transparency:** Every step of the procurement process must be documented and available for audit review.
- **Fairness:** Vendor selection must be based on objective evaluation criteria, free from personal relationships or undisclosed conflicts of interest.
- **Compliance:** All procurement activity must comply with applicable Indian laws, GST requirements, TDS obligations, and the company's internal policies.

- **Segregation:** The person who initiates a purchase must not be the sole approver of that purchase.

Procurement Thresholds

Expenditure Range	Minimum Quotes Required	Approval Authority
Below ₹10,000	Single quote acceptable	Department Head
₹10,001 – ₹1,00,000	Minimum 2 quotes required	Finance Manager
₹1,00,001 – ₹5,00,000	Minimum 3 quotes required	Finance Manager + CFO
Above ₹5,00,000	Formal tender / RFP process	Board Approval

Prohibited Practices

- Splitting purchase orders to avoid approval thresholds
- Purchasing from a vendor not listed in the approved vendor register without prior Procurement Officer authorisation
- Accepting gifts, hospitality, or any benefit from a vendor in excess of ₹2,000 in aggregate per year without written disclosure to the Finance Manager
- Authorising purchase orders for items already received without a valid purchase order (retrospective POs)
- Using personal credit cards for company purchases except under the emergency exception process defined in Section 17

No PO, No Pay

CoreAxis Technologies operates a strict No PO, No Pay policy. Vendors must not be paid unless a valid Purchase Order, approved in accordance with this policy, exists in the system. Invoices received without a corresponding PO will be placed on hold pending

retrospective PO approval. Repeated instances of bypassing the PO process will result in escalation to the CFO.

Emergency Procurement

In circumstances where a genuine business emergency requires immediate purchase without the standard approval cycle, the Finance Manager may authorise emergency procurement up to ₹1,00,000. Emergency purchases must be documented within 24 hours with a full record of what was purchased, from whom, at what price, and why the standard process was bypassed. A retrospective purchase order must be raised within two business days.

Emergency procurement authority above ₹1,00,000 rests with the CFO.

Section 9

Purchase Request Process

Every purchase must begin with a formal Purchase Request (PR). No vendor may be contacted for pricing, and no commitment may be made, until a PR has been raised and approved through the correct channel.

How to Raise a Purchase Request

Purchase Requests are submitted via Jira under the Finance project queue.

The requestor must provide the following information:

- Description of goods or services required

- Estimated cost and currency
- Cost centre / project code to be charged
- CAPEX or OPEX classification
- Business justification (one paragraph minimum)
- Preferred vendor (if applicable, with justification for single-source)
- Required-by date
- Name of the requesting department head

Purchase Request Approval Workflow

Requestor raises PR in Jira with all mandatory fields completed

Jira automatically notifies the department head for budget confirmation

Department head confirms budget availability and approves or rejects the PR within 2 business days

Approved PR is routed to the Procurement Officer for vendor sourcing

Procurement Officer obtains required quotes and recommends a vendor

Finance Manager reviews and approves the purchase (or escalates for higher-value items per the authority matrix)

Approved PR is converted to a Purchase Order by the Procurement Officer

Purchase Order is issued to the vendor

Urgent Purchase Requests

Purchase Requests marked as urgent (required within 48 hours) bypass the standard queue and are reviewed by the Finance Manager directly. Urgent

classification must include a written explanation. Repeated non-urgent PRs flagged as urgent will result in the requestor losing the urgent designation capability.

Recurring Purchases

For recurring expenditures (monthly SaaS subscriptions, utilities, regular service contracts), a standing Purchase Request may be created at the start of the financial year. Standing PRs cover the entire year's expected expenditure and must be renewed at each budget cycle. The Procurement Officer maintains the standing PR register and alerts the Finance Manager when renewals are due.

Note

All Purchase Requests for software, cloud services, and API subscriptions must include confirmation from the Information Security department that the vendor's data handling practices comply with CoreAxis Technologies' information security policy. Security clearance is a mandatory field on the PR form for technology-related purchases.

Section 10

Purchase Order Standards

A Purchase Order (PO) is a legally binding commitment by CoreAxis Technologies to purchase goods or services from a vendor at a specified price and on specified terms. POs must be prepared on the company's official PO template and issued from the approved system (Zoho Books or Dynamics 365) only.

Mandatory PO Fields

- Purchase Order number (system-generated, sequential)
- CoreAxis Technologies GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXXXXZ (Chennai) or 29XXXXXXXXXXXXZ (Bengaluru)
- PO date and valid-until date
- Vendor name, address, and GSTIN
- Line item description, quantity, unit price, and total
- Applicable GST rate (IGST, CGST + SGST) and GST amount
- Delivery address or service location
- Payment terms (e.g., Net 30, Net 45)
- Approver name and designation
- Cost centre / project code
- Reference to approved Purchase Request number

PO Numbering Convention

POs follow the format: PO-YYYY-NNNN. For example, PO-2025-0147 is the 147th purchase order of FY 2025–26. The system generates this number automatically. Manual PO numbers are not permitted.

PO Amendments

If the scope, price, or terms of a purchase change after PO issuance, a formal PO amendment must be issued. Amendments require the same approval level as the original PO. Verbal amendments or email modifications that are not reflected in the system are not recognised by the Finance Department and will not be honoured at payment processing.

Goods Receipt and Service Confirmation

Before any invoice is processed for payment, the receiving department must confirm in Jira that:

- Goods have been physically received in full and are in acceptable condition, or
- Services have been delivered in accordance with the agreed scope of work

The goods/service confirmation must be made by the requesting department, not by Finance. AP Executives must not process payment without a documented confirmation of receipt or service delivery.

PO Type	Confirmation Method	Who Confirms
Hardware / Equipment	Goods Receipt Note (GRN) in Jira/Zoho	IT Department or Requestor
Software Licences	Licence activation confirmation email	IT Department
Cloud Subscriptions	Console access confirmation	IT or AI/ML Team
Professional Services	Service Completion Certificate	Project Manager
Office Supplies	Delivery receipt signed by Office Admin	Office Admin

Section 11

Vendor Selection and Management

CoreAxis Technologies maintains a curated register of approved vendors. All procurement activity must be directed to vendors on the approved register.

Engaging a new vendor requires the completion of the vendor onboarding process before any purchase order is issued.

Vendor Onboarding Requirements

Before a new vendor is added to the approved vendor register, the Procurement Officer must collect and verify the following documents:

- Certificate of Incorporation or business registration document
- GST Registration Certificate and GSTIN
- PAN Card of the company or proprietor
- Bank account details (cancelled cheque or bank certificate)
- Address proof (utility bill, lease agreement)
- Signed Vendor Declaration Form (conflict of interest, compliance, data handling)
- Completed Vendor Information Form with primary contact details
- Information Security clearance confirmation (mandatory for technology vendors)

Vendor Evaluation Criteria

Vendor selection is based on a scored evaluation framework. The Procurement Officer scores each vendor against the following criteria:

Criterion	Weight
Financial stability and track record	20%
Technical capability and product quality	25%
Pricing competitiveness	25%
Compliance and regulatory standing	15%
References and client testimonials	10%

Preferred Vendor Status

Vendors who consistently meet or exceed performance standards and offer competitive pricing may be designated as Preferred Vendors. Preferred Vendors are reviewed annually. The designation provides priority consideration in procurement decisions but does not exempt the vendor from competitive quoting requirements for individual purchases.

Vendor Performance Reviews

The Procurement Officer conducts semi-annual vendor performance reviews for all vendors with annual spend above ₹5,00,000. Performance is rated against agreed SLAs, delivery timeliness, invoice accuracy, and responsiveness. Poor performers are placed on a Vendor Improvement Notice (VIN) and given 90 days to remediate. Vendors who fail to improve are removed from the approved register.

Vendor Payment Terms

Standard payment terms for CoreAxis Technologies are Net 30 from the date of invoice approval. Terms may be negotiated to Net 45 for contracts above ₹10,00,000 if approved by the Finance Manager. No advance payments above ₹50,000 are made without Finance Manager approval and a corresponding bank guarantee or performance bond from the vendor.

Banking Detail Changes

Any request to change a vendor's bank account details must be verified by the Finance Manager by calling the vendor's known telephone number (not a number provided in the change request email). All banking detail changes must be documented with the

verification call record before the change is made in the system. This is a mandatory fraud prevention control.

Section 12

Invoice Processing

Invoice processing at CoreAxis Technologies follows a three-way matching process: the invoice is matched against the approved Purchase Order and the goods/service receipt confirmation before payment is approved. This control is mandatory for all vendor invoices above ₹5,000.

Invoice Receipt and Registration

Vendor invoices must be sent to the dedicated AP email address (accounts-payable@coreaxis.in). Invoices received by individual employees must be forwarded to this address immediately. Invoices sent directly to non-Finance personnel that are not forwarded within two business days are the financial responsibility of the receiving employee if a late payment penalty results.

GST Invoice Requirements

CoreAxis Technologies only processes invoices that comply with the GST Act.

A valid GST invoice must contain:

- Vendor's GSTIN
- CoreAxis Technologies' GSTIN and registered address
- Invoice number and date
- Description of goods or services

- HSN/SAC code
- Taxable value, GST rate, and GST amount (CGST + SGST or IGST)
- Total invoice amount
- Payment terms

Non-compliant invoices are returned to the vendor with a written request for correction. The payment clock does not start until a corrected, compliant invoice is received.

Three-Way Matching Process

Invoice Matching and Approval

AP Executive receives invoice at accounts-payable@coreaxis.in and logs it in Zoho Books within 1 business day

AP Executive retrieves the corresponding PO number from the invoice

AP Executive verifies: (a) Invoice matches PO — same vendor, same items, same price;
(b) Goods receipt / service completion confirmation exists in Jira

If three-way match is successful, AP Executive posts the invoice in Zoho Books and routes for Finance Manager approval

Finance Manager approves or queries the invoice within 3 business days

Approved invoice is added to the next payment run based on payment terms

Payment is executed and the invoice is marked as paid in Zoho Books

Invoice Discrepancy Handling

If a discrepancy is found during matching (price difference, quantity mismatch, missing PO), the AP Executive places the invoice on hold and notifies the vendor in writing within 2 business days. The hold is recorded in Zoho Books with the discrepancy code. The Finance Manager is notified of any hold exceeding ₹1,00,000 or aged over 10 business days.

TDS on Vendor Payments

The AP Executive is responsible for calculating and deducting TDS on applicable vendor payments in accordance with the Income Tax Act. Common TDS sections applicable to CoreAxis Technologies include:

Nature of Payment	TDS Section	Standard Rate
Contractor / sub-contractor (company)	194C	2%
Professional / technical services	194J	10%
Rent (above threshold)	194I	2% / 10%
Commission / brokerage	194H	5%
Interest on loans	194A	10%

Section 13

Accounts Payable Procedures

The Accounts Payable function manages all outgoing payments from CoreAxis Technologies to vendors, service providers, landlords, and government

authorities. The AP team is responsible for processing payments accurately, on time, and in full compliance with applicable tax laws.

Payment Schedule

CoreAxis Technologies runs two payment cycles each month:

- **Cycle 1:** 10th of the month — covers invoices approved by the 5th
- **Cycle 2:** 25th of the month — covers invoices approved by the 20th

Invoices received and approved after the 20th will be processed in the following month's Cycle 1, unless an exception is approved by the Finance Manager.

Payment Methods

Method	Use Case	Approval Required
NEFT	Routine vendor payments below ₹2 lakh	Finance Manager
RTGS	High-value payments ₹2 lakh and above	Finance Manager + CFO
Cheque	Payees without NEFT facility (rare)	Finance Manager
UPI	Emergency small payments below ₹1,000	Finance Manager
Demand Draft	Government/regulatory payments as required	Finance Manager

AP Ageing Management

The AP Executive produces and reviews the AP ageing report weekly. The report is segmented into: 0–30 days, 31–60 days, 61–90 days, and over 90

days. Invoices approaching their due date are flagged for the next payment cycle. Invoices overdue by more than 15 days are escalated to the Finance Manager with a root-cause explanation.

Vendor Reconciliation

On a quarterly basis, the AP Executive reconciles CoreAxis Technologies' AP ledger against vendor statements for all vendors with annual spend above ₹5,00,000. Discrepancies are investigated and resolved within 30 days of the reconciliation date. Reconciliation records are maintained for seven years per the Record Retention Policy.

Statutory Payments

The following statutory payments are managed by the AP Executive and Accountant, with Finance Manager oversight. All statutory payments must be made by the legally mandated due date. Late payment attracts penalties and interest that will be reported as a control failure in the internal audit report.

Payment Type	Due Date	Responsible
TDS Deposit (Tax Deducted at Source)	7th of following month	Accountant / AP Executive
GST Payment (GSTR-3B)	20th of following month	Accountant
Provident Fund (PF)	15th of following month	Payroll Specialist

Employee State Insurance (ESI)	15th of following month	Payroll Specialist
Professional Tax (Tamil Nadu / Karnataka)	As per state schedule	Payroll Specialist

Statutory Payment Compliance

Failure to make statutory payments on time is a serious compliance breach. The Accountant must confirm each statutory payment by uploading the payment confirmation challan to the Finance SharePoint folder within 24 hours of payment. The Finance Manager reviews all statutory payment records monthly.

Section 14

Accounts Receivable Procedures

The Accounts Receivable function is responsible for ensuring that revenue earned by CoreAxis Technologies is billed promptly, collected efficiently, and recorded accurately. Effective AR management is critical to the company's cash flow and working capital position.

Client Invoicing Process

Invoice Generation and Delivery

Project Manager or Sales team confirms billing milestone is reached and notifies AR Executive

AR Executive generates a GST-compliant invoice in Zoho Books using the standard invoice template

Invoice is reviewed by the Finance Manager for amounts above ₹5,00,000

Invoice is issued to the client via email with PDF attachment and shared drive link

Invoice is recorded in the AR ledger with the expected payment date based on agreed credit terms

AR Executive follows up with the client 5 days before the due date

Standard Credit Terms

CoreAxis Technologies' standard credit terms are Net 30 from invoice date.

Terms above Net 45 require Finance Manager approval. Upfront payment terms (50% advance, 50% on delivery) are mandatory for new clients and may be required for projects above ₹25,00,000 at the Finance Manager's discretion.

Collections Process

Days Overdue	Action	Responsible
1–7 days	Courtesy reminder email	AR Executive
8–15 days	Formal written notice + phone call	AR Executive
16–30 days	Escalation to client account manager and Finance Manager	Finance Manager
31–60 days	Senior management escalation, payment plan discussion	Finance Manager + CFO
Over 60 days	Legal notice, debt collection referral	CFO + Legal Counsel

Advance Payments and Deposits

Advance payments received from clients are recorded as liabilities (Advance from Customers) in Zoho Books and are not recognised as revenue until the corresponding service is delivered. The AR Executive tracks advance balances monthly and notifies the Finance Manager of any advances held for more than 90 days without corresponding service delivery.

Credit Notes

Credit notes may be issued to correct invoicing errors, provide agreed discounts, or reflect service shortfalls. All credit notes must be approved by the Finance Manager before issue. Credit notes above ₹1,00,000 require CFO approval. The AR Executive maintains a credit note register and reconciles it monthly.

Bad Debt Write-Off

A debt is classified as doubtful when overdue by more than 90 days. A provision for doubtful debts is raised at 50% of the outstanding balance. A debt is written off when recovery is assessed as unviable, supported by legal counsel opinion or court order. Write-offs require Board approval for amounts above ₹5,00,000. Written-off balances are maintained in a memorandum register for seven years for tax and legal purposes.

Section 15

Employee Expense Reimbursement

CoreAxis Technologies reimburses employees for legitimate, pre-approved business expenses incurred in the course of their duties. Reimbursement is a

privilege, not a right, and is subject to the submission of complete documentation and adherence to this policy.

Eligible Expenses

- Business travel — flights, trains, taxis, ride-hailing (with receipts)
- Accommodation for approved business travel
- Client entertainment (meals) — up to ₹2,500 per person per event
- Conference or training registration fees
- Stationery and office supplies required for work not available in office
- Professional development books or materials (up to ₹3,000 per year)
- Mobile data or internet costs for remote work (as per approved policy)

Ineligible Expenses

- Personal meals, alcohol, or entertainment not directly related to business
- Luxury travel upgrades (business class, first class without prior CFO approval)
- Personal subscriptions or software licences
- Fines, penalties, or traffic violations
- Gifts above ₹2,000 per recipient per year
- Expenses incurred by a family member
- Expenses without original receipts or documentary evidence

Expense Claim Submission Process

Expense Reimbursement Workflow

Employee completes the Expense Claim Form in Google Workspace within 30 days of incurring the expense

All original receipts and supporting documents are attached (digital scans accepted)

Completed form submitted to reporting manager for approval via Jira workflow

Reporting manager reviews and approves within 3 business days

Finance Manager reviews claims above ₹5,000 or those with any deviation from policy

AP Executive processes reimbursement in the next payment cycle

Employee receives reimbursement via NEFT to their registered bank account

30-Day Submission Rule

Expense claims submitted more than 30 days after the expense was incurred will not be reimbursed without written approval from the Finance Manager. Claims submitted more than 90 days after the expense are automatically rejected. The Finance team will not make exceptions to this rule regardless of personal circumstances — employees are expected to submit claims promptly.

Expense Claim Audit

The Finance Manager conducts a random sample audit of 20% of all expense claims each quarter. Any claims found to be fraudulent, inflated, or in violation of policy will be recovered from the employee's salary, and the matter may be referred for disciplinary action. Patterns of non-compliance will be reported to HR.

Section 16

Business Travel Claims

Business travel must be pre-approved before any bookings are made.

Employees who book travel without prior approval assume personal financial responsibility for those bookings.

Travel Pre-Approval

Travel requests must be submitted via Jira at least 5 business days before the travel date (or 10 business days for international travel). The request must state the business purpose, destination, dates, estimated cost, and cost centre.

Approval is required from the reporting manager and the Finance Manager for travel costs above ₹15,000.

Travel Booking

Employees must use the company's preferred travel booking channels where available. Self-booking via personal platforms is permitted where corporate channels are unavailable, subject to adherence to the fare limits below.

Travel Allowance Limits

Cate gory	Chennai/Bengaluru (Local)	Domestic Travel	International Travel
Flights (Economy)	N/A	Lowest available economy fare	Economy; business class requires CFO approval
Train	AC 2-Tier	AC 1-Tier for overnight journeys	N/A
Taxi / Cab	Up to ₹1,500/day	Up to ₹2,000/day	As per local standard

Hotel	N/A	Up to ₹5,000/night	Up to USD 150/night
Daily Food Allowance	₹500 (no receipt needed)	₹1,000/day	USD 50/day
Local Transport (Bengaluru ↔ Chennai)	—	Actual cost, economy	—

Travel Advance

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 80% of the estimated travel cost. Advances must be requested via the Finance Department at least 3 business days before travel. The advance must be reconciled with actual expenses within 7 business days of the employee returning from travel. Unreconciled advances are recovered from the employee's salary if not settled within 14 business days of return.

International Travel

International travel requires Finance Manager and CFO approval regardless of cost. Employees travelling internationally must arrange appropriate travel insurance through the company's approved insurance provider before departure. Foreign currency advances are subject to RBI regulations and must be obtained through an authorised dealer. Per diem allowances for international

travel are set in USD and converted at the RBI reference rate on the date of advance.

Section 17

Corporate Credit Card Policy

Corporate credit cards are issued to senior employees who regularly incur business expenses on behalf of CoreAxis Technologies. Card issuance is not automatic and is subject to approval by the Finance Manager and CFO.

Card Eligibility

Corporate cards are issued to: Finance Manager, Department Heads, and employees who incur recurring business travel or client entertainment expenses above ₹10,000 per month on average. Eligibility is reviewed annually.

Permitted Usage

- Airline and railway ticket bookings for approved business travel
- Hotel bookings for approved business travel
- Client entertainment within the approved limits (Section 15)
- Conference and event registrations
- Software or cloud subscriptions where no purchase order mechanism exists and prior approval has been obtained

Prohibited Usage

- Personal expenses of any kind
- Cash advances from ATMs (unless authorised in writing by the Finance Manager for an emergency)
- Purchases for non-business purposes
- Purchases for third parties not covered by an approved expense

- Gambling, adult entertainment, or any illegal activity

Statement Reconciliation

Cardholders must submit a fully reconciled statement with receipts for every transaction within 7 business days of the monthly statement date. Transactions without receipts are treated as personal expenses and recovered from the employee. The Finance Manager reviews all card statements before approving payment of the card bill.

Card Misuse Consequences

Misuse of a corporate credit card, including personal purchases, falsified expense descriptions, or failure to submit timely statements, will result in immediate card cancellation, full recovery of the misused amount from salary, a formal written warning, and — for serious or repeated misuse — termination of employment. Card misuse may also constitute a criminal offence under the Indian Penal Code.

Lost or Stolen Cards

Card loss or theft must be reported to the card-issuing bank within 30 minutes of discovery and to the Finance Manager within 1 hour. The Finance Manager will block the card and arrange for a replacement. Liability for fraudulent transactions after proper notification rests with the bank. Liability for transactions before notification rests with the cardholder.

Section 18

Payroll Administration

Payroll at CoreAxis Technologies is processed monthly and covers all permanent employees, contractual employees on the payroll, and probationary employees. The payroll cycle runs from the 1st to the last day of each month,

with salary credited on the last working day of the month or the 1st of the following month if technical processing requires it.

Payroll Input Cut-off

All payroll inputs must be submitted to the Payroll Specialist by the 20th of each month. Inputs submitted after the cut-off may be reflected in the following month's payroll. Input sources include:

- HR — new joiner information, salary revision letters, exit dates, leave encashment
- Department Heads — approved overtime, special allowances
- Finance Manager — salary advance recoveries, loan instalments
- Payroll Specialist — attendance data, leave records, statutory calculations

Payroll Processing Controls

- Payroll must be prepared by the Payroll Specialist and reviewed by the Accountant before processing
- The Finance Manager approves the payroll register before salary is disbursed
- Salary is disbursed only to bank accounts registered in the employee's name in the HR system
- Changes to employee bank accounts require two-step verification with the HR department before payroll update
- No salary advance exceeding one month's gross salary is permitted without Finance Manager and HR Director approval
- Ghost employee checks are conducted quarterly by cross-referencing payroll data with HR active employee records

Payroll Reconciliation

After each payroll run, the Payroll Specialist prepares a payroll reconciliation that compares the current month's payroll against the previous month's. Variances above 5% in total payroll cost or above ₹10,000 for any individual employee must be explained with reference to the input document that authorised the change.

Payslip Distribution

Payslips are generated for all employees by the 2nd of the following month and delivered via the HR information system or email. Payslips contain: gross salary components, statutory deductions (PF, ESI, PT, TDS), net salary, YTD totals, and leave balance. Payslips are password-protected documents; the password is communicated separately through the HR system.

Section 19

Salary Processing

Salary processing at CoreAxis Technologies follows a structured monthly workflow to ensure accuracy, compliance, and on-time payment. The Payroll Specialist is the process owner, with the Finance Manager as the final approver.

Salary Structure

CoreAxis Technologies' standard salary structure comprises the following components:

Component	Taxability	Notes
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Basic Salary	Fully taxable	Minimum 40% of CTC
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	Partially exempt (Section 10(13A))	Exempt up to prescribed limits
Special Allowance	Fully taxable	Balancing component
Leave Travel Allowance (LTA)	Exempt (Section 10(5))	Twice in 4-year block; with travel proof
Employer PF Contribution	Exempt up to ₹1,50,000/year	12% of basic salary
Performance Bonus	Fully taxable	Discretionary, paid quarterly or annually
Meal Vouchers / Sodexo	Exempt up to ₹26,400/year	If applicable

Monthly Payroll Workflow

Monthly Salary Processing Steps

1st–20th: Payroll Specialist collects all inputs from HR and department heads

20th–22nd: Payroll Specialist processes payroll in payroll software, calculates gross salary, deductions (PF, ESI, PT, TDS), and net pay

23rd: Payroll register submitted to Accountant for review

24th: Accountant reviews and certifies payroll accuracy, escalates discrepancies to Finance Manager

25th: Finance Manager reviews and approves payroll register

26th–27th: AP Executive uploads NEFT salary file to banking portal

28th or last working day: Salaries credited to employee accounts

30th of following month: Payslips distributed via HR system

New Joiner and Exit Processing

For new joiners, payroll is processed on a pro-rata basis for the number of days worked in the month of joining. For employees who resign or are terminated, payroll is processed for the notice period served and any leave encashment due, less any outstanding salary advances or loan recoveries. Full and final settlement is processed within 45 days of the last working day.

Salary Revision Cycle

CoreAxis Technologies conducts an annual salary review in April, aligned to the start of the financial year. Salary revisions are communicated by HR via revised offer letters. The Payroll Specialist updates the payroll master in the system only upon receipt of the signed revised offer letter and HR confirmation.

Backdated salary revisions require Finance Manager approval.

Section 20

Employee Benefits Administration

CoreAxis Technologies provides a defined package of statutory and supplementary employee benefits. The Finance Department is responsible for the financial administration and compliance of all employee benefit programmes.

Statutory Benefits

Provident Fund (PF)

All employees drawing a basic salary up to ₹15,000 per month are mandatorily enrolled in the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF). Employees above this threshold may opt out. The contribution rate is 12% from both employer and employee on basic salary plus DA. Employer contributions are remitted to the EPFO by the 15th of the following month.

Employee State Insurance (ESI)

Employees whose gross salary is below ₹21,000 per month are covered under ESI. Employee contribution is 0.75% of gross salary; employer contribution is 3.25%. ESI contributions are remitted by the 15th of the following month. ESI covers medical, sickness, maternity, and disability benefits.

Gratuity

Employees who have completed 5 or more years of continuous service are entitled to gratuity under the Payment of Gratuity Act. Gratuity is calculated as $(\text{Basic Salary} + \text{DA}) \times 15/26 \times \text{Number of Years of Service}$. CoreAxis Technologies provisions for gratuity liability monthly in the books of accounts. Gratuity is paid at the time of separation.

Supplementary Benefits

Benefit	Coverage	Notes
Group Health Insurance	Employee + Spouse + 2 children	Sum insured: ₹3,00,000 per family; employer-paid premium
Group Term Life Insurance	3× annual CTC	Employer-paid; nominees registered with HR
Personal Accident Insurance	2× annual CTC	Employer-paid
Leave Encashment	Up to 15 days per year	Subject to HR leave policy
Professional Development	Up to ₹25,000 per year	Pre-approved by department head
Internet / Work-from-Home Allowance	₹1,000/month	For hybrid employees

Benefits Accounting

All benefit-related costs are expensed monthly in the correct cost centre.

Actuarial valuations for gratuity and leave encashment liabilities are obtained annually from an independent actuary and are reflected in the annual financial statements in compliance with Ind AS 19 (Employee Benefits).

Section 21

Tax Compliance

Tax compliance is a non-negotiable obligation for CoreAxis Technologies. The Accountant and Payroll Specialist manage day-to-day tax filings under the supervision of the Finance Manager. External tax advisors are engaged for complex matters, advance tax planning, and representation before tax authorities.

Goods and Services Tax (GST)

CoreAxis Technologies is registered for GST in both Tamil Nadu (GSTIN: 33XXXXXXXXXXXXXZ) and Karnataka (GSTIN: 29XXXXXXXXXXXXXZ). As a supplier of IT services, CoreAxis Technologies charges 18% GST (SAC 9983) on all taxable supplies.

GST Filing Calendar

Return	Frequency	Due Date
GSTR-1 (Outward supplies)	Monthly	11th of the following month
GSTR-3B (Summary return & payment)	Monthly	20th of the following month
GSTR-9 (Annual return)	Annual	31st December of the following year
GSTR-9C (Reconciliation statement)	Annual	31st December of the following year

Income Tax — Corporate

CoreAxis Technologies is subject to Indian corporate income tax. The Accountant prepares advance tax calculations quarterly. Advance tax is paid in

four instalments: 15% by June 15, 45% by September 15, 75% by December 15, and 100% by March 15.

Tax Deducted at Source (TDS)

TDS is deducted on salary payments (Section 192), vendor payments (Sections 194C, 194J, 194I, 194H), and other payments as applicable. TDS is deposited with the government by the 7th of the following month (30th April for March). Quarterly TDS returns (Forms 24Q, 26Q) are filed by the 31st of the month following the quarter end.

Research and Development Tax Benefit

CoreAxis Technologies claims a weighted deduction under Section 35(2AB) of the Income Tax Act for approved R&D expenditure on in-house research. The Financial Analyst maintains a detailed R&D expenditure register, and the Finance Manager ensures the R&D approval from the Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR) is current. All AI model training, RAG system development, and computer vision R&D expenditure is coded to the R&D cost centre and tracked separately for this purpose.

Transfer Pricing

If CoreAxis Technologies engages in transactions with related parties (group companies, subsidiaries), those transactions must be conducted at arm's length and documented as required under the Income Tax Act (Sections 92–92F). The Finance Manager is responsible for maintaining contemporaneous transfer pricing documentation.

Section 22

Financial Reporting

CoreAxis Technologies produces financial reports at monthly, quarterly, and annual frequencies. Reports are prepared by the Financial Analyst and reviewed by the Finance Manager before distribution. Financial reports are distributed on a strict need-to-know basis and are classified as confidential.

Monthly Reporting Package

The monthly management report is distributed by the 10th of the following month and includes:

- Profit and Loss statement (actual vs. budget vs. prior year)
- Balance Sheet summary
- Cash flow statement (actual and rolling 3-month forecast)
- Budget-versus-actual variance report by cost centre
- Accounts receivable and accounts payable ageing summaries
- Cloud infrastructure cost report (AWS + Azure)
- Software and SaaS subscription cost report
- Headcount and payroll cost summary
- Finance Manager commentary on key variances and risks

Monthly Closing Procedures

Month-End Close Checklist

All revenue (AR invoices) posted for the month by day 1 of close

All vendor invoices received and processed by day 2

Payroll journal entry posted and verified against payroll register by day 3

Accruals for services received but not invoiced raised by day 4

Prepayments and deferred revenue adjustments processed by day 4

Depreciation and amortisation entries posted by day 5

Bank reconciliations completed for all bank accounts by day 5

Inter-company or inter-branch entries reconciled by day 6

Trial balance reviewed by Accountant and Finance Manager by day 7

Management report draft prepared by Financial Analyst by day 8

Finance Manager reviews and approves report by day 10

Report distributed to CFO and Department Heads by day 10

Annual Financial Statements

Annual financial statements are prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) and the Companies Act, 2013. The statements include: Balance Sheet, Statement of Profit and Loss, Statement of Cash Flows, and Notes to Accounts. Annual statements are audited by the external statutory auditor and adopted by the Board. The final audited statements must be filed with the Registrar of Companies (ROC) within the prescribed statutory timelines.

Reporting Tools

Power BI is the primary tool for management dashboards and real-time financial reporting. Power BI connects directly to Zoho Books and Dynamics 365 data sources. All Power BI reports used for external or Board reporting must be certified by the Finance Manager before use. Excel-based reports remain the secondary tool for ad-hoc analysis and detailed reconciliations.

Section 23

Cost Management

Cost management at CoreAxis Technologies is an ongoing process, not an event confined to budget season. The Finance Department monitors spending continuously and provides the business with actionable insights to control costs without compromising operational capability.

Cost Categories and Monitoring Frequency

Cost Category	Monitoring Frequency	Responsible
Salaries and benefits	Monthly	Payroll Specialist + Finance Manager

Cloud infrastructur e (AWS/Azure)	Weekly	Financial Analyst
SaaS subscription s	Monthly	Procureme nt Officer + Financial Analyst
Third-party API usage	Weekly	Financial Analyst + IT
Travel and entertainme nt	Monthly	Finance Manager
Office and facilities	Monthly	Finance Manager
Professional services	Per engagement	Finance Manager

Cost Reduction Initiatives

The Finance Manager identifies and tracks cost reduction opportunities through the Annual Cost Management Plan, updated each April. Initiatives are tracked in Jira with assigned owners, target savings, and completion dates. Progress is reviewed quarterly.

Variance Analysis

Any cost centre spending more than 10% above its approved monthly budget triggers a formal variance review. The Financial Analyst prepares a variance memo for the Finance Manager within 3 business days of the month-end report. The variance memo must explain: the cause of the overrun, whether it is a

timing difference or a structural overspend, and the proposed remediation action.

Zero-Based Review

Every three years, CoreAxis Technologies conducts a zero-based review of all OPEX categories. In a zero-based review, each cost line must be justified afresh — no cost is automatically carried forward. The Finance Manager leads the process, engaging department heads to justify every line item from a base of zero. Outputs are incorporated into the subsequent annual budget.

Section 24

Project Cost Allocation

CoreAxis Technologies allocates costs to individual projects to enable accurate profitability analysis, client billing, and R&D cost tracking. The Finance Department works with project managers and department heads to ensure all direct and indirect project costs are captured correctly.

Direct Project Costs

Direct costs are those incurred specifically for a project and include:

- Labour costs of employees directly working on the project (tracked via timesheets)

- Cloud infrastructure provisioned for the project (tagged in AWS/Azure with the project code)
- Third-party API usage attributed to the project (tracked via API key or endpoint logging)
- Software licences or tools procured specifically for the project
- External vendor or contractor costs for project-specific work
- Travel costs incurred for client site visits or project-related travel

Indirect Cost Allocation

Indirect costs (overhead) are allocated to projects using a pre-determined overhead allocation rate, calculated annually by the Financial Analyst. The rate is expressed as a percentage of direct labour cost and covers: office occupancy, corporate software licences, Finance and HR overheads, and shared IT infrastructure. The overhead rate is reviewed and updated each April.

Timesheet Requirements

All billable project staff are required to submit weekly timesheets by Monday 9:00 AM for the preceding week. Timesheets must be accurate, granular (minimum 30-minute slots), and submitted via Jira. The Financial Analyst extracts timesheet data monthly and applies the agreed billing rates or cost rates to calculate project labour costs. Departments with persistent timesheet non-compliance will be escalated to the relevant department head by the Finance Manager.

Project Profitability Reports

The Financial Analyst produces a project profitability report monthly for all active client-facing projects with a contract value above ₹5,00,000. The report shows: contracted revenue, costs incurred to date, projected total cost, earned

margin, and variance against the project budget. Project managers and the Finance Manager receive this report by the 12th of each month.

AI Project Budgeting

AI and machine learning projects require a dedicated budget line for:

- Model training compute costs (GPU hours — AWS EC2 P instances, Azure NC series, or GCP A100 nodes)
- Model inference serving costs (real-time API endpoints, batch processing)
- Dataset storage and preprocessing compute
- Third-party foundational model API usage (e.g., OpenAI, Anthropic, Cohere, Google Gemini)
- MLOps tooling and experiment tracking (e.g., MLflow, Weights & Biases)

AI project budget submissions must include an AI Cost Model showing estimated GPU hours, model parameters, training runs, and inference volumes. The Financial Analyst reviews all AI Cost Models before budget approval.

Section 25

Software Subscription Management

Software subscriptions represent a significant and growing cost at CoreAxis Technologies. Given the nature of our work as an AI software company, the volume and diversity of SaaS tools, AI APIs, and development platforms is high. The Procurement Officer and Financial Analyst jointly manage the software subscription portfolio.

Software Subscription Register

The Procurement Officer maintains a Software Subscription Register in Confluence. The register contains, for each subscription:

- Software name and vendor
- Business purpose and department
- Number of licences
- Annual cost in INR
- Renewal date
- Renewal notice period
- Contract owner (department head)
- Last utilisation review date
- GitHub Enterprise or IT tracking reference (for developer tools)

Subscription Categories

Category	Examples	Review Frequency
Development Tools	GitHub Enterprise, JetBrains, VS Code extensions	Annually
AI / ML APIs	OpenAI API, Anthropic API, Google Gemini, Cohere	Monthly (usage-based)
Cloud Services	AWS, Azure, GCP (managed under Section 26)	Weekly
Productivity &	Google Workspace,	Annually

Collaboration	Microsoft Teams, Slack	
Finance Systems	Zoho Books, TallyPrime, Dynamics 365	Annually
Security Tools	SIEM, endpoint protection, vulnerability scanners	Annually
Data & Analytics	Power BI, Tableau, data marketplace subscriptions	Annually

Subscription Approval Process

A new software subscription request follows the standard Purchase Request process (Section 9). In addition, the requestor must provide: business justification, expected user count, alternative tools evaluated, data handling and security assessment, and Integration Security sign-off from the Information Security department. No subscription may be activated until it appears in the Software Subscription Register and the PO has been issued.

Licence Utilisation Review

The Procurement Officer and Financial Analyst conduct a semi-annual licence utilisation review. Any tool with licence utilisation below 60% triggers a licence reduction review. The contract owner is notified and given 30 days to demonstrate business need for the full licence count. Unused licences are cancelled at the next renewal unless business need is confirmed by the department head.

Open-Source Software Compliance

CoreAxis Technologies uses open-source software extensively in its AI and engineering work. The use of open-source components must comply with the applicable licence terms (MIT, Apache, GPL, etc.). Before incorporating open-source software in a commercial product, the Information Security and Legal teams must confirm licence compatibility. Finance is responsible for tracking costs associated with any open-source licence that requires a commercial licence for certain use cases.

Section 26

Cloud Infrastructure Cost Management

Cloud infrastructure costs are one of the most dynamic and rapidly growing cost categories at CoreAxis Technologies. Given the company's use of cloud-native platforms, GPU-intensive AI model training, and real-time inference services, cloud cost governance is treated as a strategic function, not merely an accounting task.

Cloud Cost Governance Framework

- **Tagging Policy:** All cloud resources (AWS, Azure) must be tagged with: Project Code, Cost Centre, Environment (Development/Production/Staging), and Owner (department or team). Untagged resources are flagged daily via automated billing alerts and reported to the Finance Manager weekly.
- **Budget Alerts:** AWS Budgets and Azure Cost Management budgets are configured for each cost centre. Alerts are triggered at 75%, 90%, and 100% of the monthly budget. Alert notifications go to the Financial Analyst, Finance Manager, and the responsible department head.

- **Reserved Instances and Savings Plans:** The Financial Analyst reviews Reserved Instance and Savings Plan opportunities quarterly. Commitments above ₹5,00,000 per year require Finance Manager and CFO approval. All Reserved Instance purchases are tracked in the Cloud Cost Register.

GPU Usage Budgeting

GPU compute is the highest unit-cost resource in CoreAxis Technologies' cloud infrastructure. Policies governing GPU usage:

- All GPU instance provisioning above 4 hours must be raised as a Jira ticket with the project code and estimated cost before provisioning
- Long-running model training jobs must be approved by the AI/ML team lead and the Finance Manager before initiation if estimated cost exceeds ₹50,000
- Scheduled shutdowns must be configured for all GPU instances not running 24×7 production workloads. Instances left running idle for more than 4 hours after a training job completes are flagged as a waste event
- Spot Instances are the default for all non-critical training jobs; On-Demand GPU instances require Finance Manager approval

AI Model Training Cost Controls

Before initiating a model training run with an estimated cloud cost above ₹1,00,000, the AI/ML team must submit an AI Training Cost Request to the Finance Manager including: model architecture, estimated training duration, instance type, dataset size, and expected output (model accuracy targets). The Finance Manager reviews against the approved AI project budget and approves or defers the run.

Third-Party API Cost Management

Usage-based API costs (OpenAI tokens, Google Gemini calls, Anthropic Claude API, vector database queries, etc.) are monitored weekly by the Financial Analyst. Monthly API cost reports are prepared by the 5th of the following month. If API spend for a single project exceeds the budgeted amount by more than 20%, the AI/ML team lead and Finance Manager are immediately notified for intervention.

Cloud Cost Optimisation Review

The Financial Analyst and IT infrastructure team conduct a monthly cloud cost optimisation review. This review identifies:

- Unused or underutilised resources eligible for rightsizing or termination
- Reserved Instance coverage gaps and optimisation opportunities
- Storage cost optimisation (moving infrequently accessed data to cheaper tiers)
- Data transfer cost spikes and routing optimisations
- Duplicate services running in multiple environments that can be consolidated

Section 27

Asset Procurement

Asset procurement at CoreAxis Technologies covers the acquisition of tangible assets (hardware, equipment, office furniture) and certain intangible assets (software licences with multi-year terms, proprietary tools). All asset

procurement must follow the standard purchase request and purchase order process in addition to the asset-specific requirements in this section.

CAPEX vs. OPEX Classification

Assets with an individual value above ₹5,000 and a useful life greater than one year are capitalised as CAPEX. Assets below this threshold are expensed as OPEX in the period of purchase. If in doubt about the correct classification, the Accountant must obtain a written ruling from the Finance Manager before processing.

Asset Types and Capitalisation Thresholds

Asset Category	Capitalisation Threshold	Useful Life
Laptop / Desktop Workstation	₹5,000	3 years
Server Hardware	₹5,000	5 years
GPU Hardware / Accelerators	₹5,000	3–4 years
Networking Equipment	₹5,000	5 years
Mobile Devices	₹5,000	2 years
Office Furniture and Fixtures	₹5,000	5–10 years
Leasehold Improvements	Project cost	Lease term
Proprietary Software (multi-year)	₹5,000	3–5 years

Fixed Asset Register

All capitalised assets are entered into the Fixed Asset Register (FAR) in Zoho Books immediately upon receipt and commissioning. The FAR contains: asset tag number, description, vendor, acquisition date, acquisition cost, location (Chennai or Bengaluru), cost centre, useful life, depreciation method, and net book value. Asset tag labels must be affixed to all physical assets upon entry into the FAR.

Asset Assignment and Custody

Every asset is assigned to a named custodian — the employee to whom the asset is issued. Asset assignment is recorded in the FAR and signed by the custodian on the Asset Assignment Form. Custodians are responsible for the safekeeping of assigned assets. Loss or damage must be reported to Finance and IT within 24 hours. Negligence may result in recovery of the asset's net book value from the employee.

Asset Physical Verification

The Finance team conducts a physical asset verification annually (every March) across both office locations. All assets in the FAR are verified against physical existence. Assets not located during verification are flagged as missing and reported to the Finance Manager. The FAR is updated to reflect any disposal, write-off, or asset additions identified during verification.

Section 28

Asset Depreciation

CoreAxis Technologies charges depreciation on all capitalised tangible and intangible assets on a monthly basis using the Straight-Line Method (SLM), in accordance with Schedule II of the Companies Act, 2013 and applicable Ind AS standards.

Depreciation Rates

Asset Category	Useful Life	Annual Depreciation Rate (SLM)
Computers and peripherals	3 years	33.33%
Servers	5 years	20%
GPU Hardware	3 years	33.33%
Networking equipment	5 years	20%
Mobile devices	2 years	50%
Office furniture	10 years	10%
Electrical fittings	10 years	10%
Leasehold improvements	Lease term	Lease term basis
Proprietary software	3–5 years	20%–33.33%

Depreciation Calculation and Posting

Depreciation is calculated monthly by the Accountant using the FAR in Zoho Books. The depreciation journal entry is posted by the 5th of the following month as part of the monthly closing process. The depreciation entry credits the Accumulated Depreciation account and debits the relevant depreciation expense account by cost centre.

Impairment Review

If there is any indication that an asset's carrying value may exceed its recoverable amount (e.g., technological obsolescence, damage, market value decline), the Accountant must bring this to the Finance Manager's attention immediately. An impairment assessment must be conducted, and if impairment is confirmed, an impairment charge is recorded and the asset's carrying value is written down. Impairment reviews for significant asset classes are conducted annually as part of the year-end closing process.

Asset Disposal

When an asset is disposed of (sold, scrapped, donated), the Accountant calculates the gain or loss on disposal (proceeds minus net book value) and records the appropriate journal entry. Asset disposal must be authorised by the Finance Manager for assets with a cost above ₹50,000 and by the CFO for assets above ₹5,00,000. Scrapping of IT assets must follow the IT department's data destruction protocol before disposal, and the IT department must provide a data destruction certificate to Finance.

Section 29

Financial Audits

CoreAxis Technologies is subject to both internal and external audit processes. Audits are not viewed as compliance formalities — they are mechanisms for independent assurance of the integrity of the company's financial records and controls. Full cooperation with auditors is mandatory for all Finance team members and all other departments.

Statutory / External Audit

CoreAxis Technologies appoints a registered Chartered Accountancy firm as its Statutory Auditor in accordance with the Companies Act, 2013. The statutory audit covers the annual financial statements for the financial year ending March 31. The audit is expected to conclude by July 31 each year. The Finance Manager is the primary point of contact for the external auditors and is responsible for providing all requested documents, explanations, and schedules in a timely manner.

Pre-Audit Preparation Checklist

- All bank reconciliations reconciled to zero outstanding items
- Fixed Asset Register updated and physical verification completed
- All statutory payment challans filed and available
- Vendor and client confirmation letters prepared for circularisation
- Accruals and provisions schedule prepared and justified
- Related party transaction schedule prepared
- Loan and borrowing schedules reconciled to bank statements
- All inter-company and inter-branch transactions reconciled

Internal Audit

CoreAxis Technologies conducts an internal audit semi-annually (covering April–September and October–March). The internal audit is conducted by a designated internal audit team or an independent Chartered Accountant firm

engaged for this purpose. The internal audit scope includes, but is not limited to:

- Compliance with the Procurement Policy and PO process
- Expense reimbursement claims — accuracy and policy compliance
- Payroll controls — new joiner/leaver processing, ghost employee check
- Vendor master data changes and banking detail modifications
- Cloud and software subscription cost controls
- Revenue recognition and billing accuracy
- Segregation of duties — system access and approval matrix compliance

Audit Findings and Remediation

All audit findings are documented in an Audit Report. The Finance Manager prepares a written management response to each finding within 15 business days of receiving the draft report. Each finding is assigned an action owner, a remediation action, and a target completion date. Progress is tracked in Jira. Outstanding high-priority findings that are not remediated within 60 days are escalated to the CFO and Board.

Section 30

Internal Controls

Internal controls are the systems, procedures, and behaviours that CoreAxis Technologies relies on to prevent errors, detect irregularities, and ensure that financial information is reliable. The Finance Manager is the control owner for all financial controls. Control failures must be reported and investigated without delay.

Key Financial Controls

Control Area	Control	Frequency
Payments	Dual authorisation for payments > ₹1,00,000	Every transaction
Payroll	Payroll reconciliation reviewed by Finance Manager	Monthly
Vendor Master	Vendor banking changes verified by phone to known contact	Each change
Bank Reconciliation	Reviewed by Finance Manager before month close	Monthly
Expense Claims	Random 20% sample audit	Quarterly
System Access	User access review	Semi-annually
PO Compliance	Invoice-to-PO matching report	Monthly
Cloud Costs	Budget alert thresholds at 75%/90%/100%	Continuous
Asset Register	Physical verification of all assets	Annually

System Access Controls

Access to all financial systems (Zoho Books, Dynamics 365, banking portals, payroll software) is role-based and reviewed semi-annually. The Finance Manager certifies the access review. Leavers must have all access revoked

within 24 hours of departure. New access requests must be approved by the Finance Manager and implemented by IT. Shared credentials are prohibited.

Control Failure Reporting

Any Finance team member who discovers a control failure, potential fraud, or unexplained discrepancy must report it to the Finance Manager immediately. If the Finance Manager is implicated, the report must be made directly to the CFO or Chairman. Retaliation against any employee for reporting a control concern in good faith is prohibited and will be treated as a serious disciplinary matter.

Internal Control Self-Assessment

The Finance Manager conducts an annual Internal Control Self-Assessment (ICSA) in Q4 (January–March) covering all key control areas. The ICSA results are presented to the CFO and form part of the statutory audit preparedness process. Any control gaps identified in the ICSA must have a remediation plan in place before the start of the next financial year.

Section 31

Fraud Prevention

CoreAxis Technologies has zero tolerance for fraud, misappropriation, or financial dishonesty of any kind. Every employee has a responsibility to uphold financial integrity and to report any suspected fraud through the appropriate channels.

Common Fraud Risks in Technology Companies

- Ghost employees on the payroll
- Fictitious vendor invoices
- Inflated or fabricated expense claims
- Unauthorised bank account changes for vendors or employees
- Misappropriation of cloud or software resources for personal use
- AI API key sharing with unauthorised parties or use for personal projects
- Duplicate invoice submission
- PO splitting to circumvent approval thresholds
- Unauthorised system access and data manipulation

Fraud Prevention Controls

- Segregation of duties across all financial transactions (initiation, approval, recording)
- Dual authorisation for all payments above ₹1,00,000
- Monthly payroll reconciliation and quarterly ghost employee checks
- Mandatory verification protocol for all vendor banking detail changes
- Automated duplicate invoice detection in Zoho Books
- Regular internal and external audits
- Cloud usage monitoring with anomaly alerts for unusual API or compute usage
- GitHub Enterprise licence and API key usage auditing monthly

Whistleblower Policy

CoreAxis Technologies maintains a confidential reporting mechanism for employees to report suspected fraud or financial misconduct. Reports may be submitted anonymously via email to the CFO (cfo@coreaxis.in) or to the Chairman of the Board. All reports are investigated independently. The identity of a reporter who chooses to be identified is protected to the maximum extent possible.

Fraud Investigation and Consequences

Confirmed fraud at any level is subject to: immediate suspension pending investigation, full recovery of misappropriated funds, termination of employment, and referral to law enforcement. The company will pursue civil and criminal remedies in all cases of confirmed fraud. Employees who fail to report suspected fraud when they had reasonable grounds to do so may also be subject to disciplinary action.

No-Tolerance Policy

CoreAxis Technologies does not distinguish between "small" and "large" fraud for disciplinary purposes. Any fraud — regardless of the amount — is treated as a serious breach of trust and employment obligations. There are no warnings for confirmed fraud.

Section 32

Record Retention

Financial records must be retained for the minimum periods specified by applicable Indian law. Records must be stored securely, remain accessible for audit and regulatory inspection, and be disposed of appropriately when the retention period expires.

Retention Schedule

Record Type	Minimum Retention Period	Legal Basis
Books of accounts, ledgers, vouchers	8 years	Income Tax Act, s. 44AA; Compan

		ies Act, 2013
GST records and tax invoices	6 years	CGST Act, 2017
TDS returns and certificates (Form 16, 16A)	7 years	Income Tax Rules
Payroll records and payslips	8 years	PF Act, Gratuity Act, Income Tax Act
PF and ESI records	8 years	EPF Act, ESI Act
Statutory audit reports	Permanently	Compan ies Act, 2013
Board minutes and resolutions	Permanently	Compan ies Act, 2013
Vendor contracts	7 years from contract end	Indian Contract Act, Limitatio n Act
Employee expense claims	8 years	Income Tax Act
Fixed asset register	Life of asset + 8 years	Compan ies Act, 2013

Bank statements and reconciliations	8 years	Income Tax Act
Cloud cost reports and invoices	7 years	GST Act, Income Tax Act

Storage and Security Requirements

- All financial records in electronic format are stored on CoreAxis Technologies' approved cloud storage (Google Drive Finance folder), with access restricted to the Finance team and authorised auditors
- Physical records are stored in locked filing cabinets in the Chennai Finance office
- Records containing employee personal data must be handled in accordance with the company's data protection policy
- Backup copies of all critical financial data are maintained and tested quarterly by the IT department

Record Disposal

Physical records at end of retention must be shredded using a cross-cut shredder. Electronic records must be securely deleted using approved data destruction tools. The Finance Manager certifies each batch disposal in a Disposal Register. Premature disposal of records — whether accidental or intentional — must be reported to the Finance Manager and the Information Security team immediately.

Section 33

Collaboration with Other Departments

The Finance Department does not operate in isolation. Effective financial management requires structured collaboration with every department in CoreAxis Technologies. This section defines the Finance Department's key interdependencies and the expected ways of working with other teams.

Human Resources

- HR provides payroll inputs (new joiners, leavers, salary revisions, leave records) by the 20th of each month
- Finance shares payroll output for HR records by the last working day of each month
- HR coordinates with Finance for full and final settlement, gratuity, and leave encashment calculations
- HR and Finance jointly manage statutory benefit compliance (PF, ESI, gratuity, maternity benefits)

AI and Machine Learning

- The AI/ML team submits monthly GPU and API usage data to Finance for cost allocation by the 5th of each month
- AI project budget requests include the AI Cost Model reviewed by the Financial Analyst
- Finance notifies the AI/ML team when cloud or API budgets reach 75% utilisation
- Finance and AI/ML conduct a joint review of model training cost efficiency quarterly

Software Engineering

- Software Engineering raises all tool and licence procurement requests through the standard PR process

- Finance tracks software licence utilisation per team using GitHub Enterprise data and procurement records
- Project cost allocation for engineering time is based on Jira timesheet data shared by the Engineering team

Information Technology

- IT provides cloud usage reports (AWS, Azure) by the 3rd of each month for Finance processing
- IT coordinates with Finance on all CAPEX hardware procurement — from PR to asset tagging
- IT manages financial system access, enforcing Finance-approved access rights
- IT provides data destruction certificates to Finance for all disposed IT assets

Information Security

- Information Security provides mandatory sign-off on all technology vendor and subscription procurement
- Finance informs Information Security of any new vendor with access to CoreAxis data before payment is processed
- Information Security supports Finance in investigating potential financial fraud involving system access or data manipulation

Escalation and Conflict Resolution

Where a department disagrees with a Finance decision (e.g., a purchase request rejection, a budget query), the matter is first discussed between the department head and the Finance Manager. If unresolved, it is escalated to the CFO within 5 business days. Finance decisions that are overridden by senior management must be documented in writing and retained in the Finance audit file.

Section 34

Employee Responsibilities

Financial integrity at CoreAxis Technologies is not solely the responsibility of the Finance Department. Every employee who initiates, approves, or receives resources has financial responsibilities under this handbook.

All Employees

- Submit expense claims promptly, accurately, and with complete supporting documentation
- Obtain purchase approval before committing the company to any expenditure
- Follow the approved procurement process for all purchases, including small purchases
- Protect company assets assigned to them and report loss or damage immediately
- Submit accurate weekly timesheets if on a billable project
- Report suspected fraud or financial irregularity immediately to the Finance Manager or CFO
- Not use company credit cards, petty cash, or company accounts for personal purposes
- Not share financial system credentials with any other person
- Not commit to any contract, purchase, or financial obligation on behalf of CoreAxis Technologies without written authorisation

Department Heads

- Manage their departmental budget within approved limits and flag variances proactively

- Review and certify expense claims from direct reports before submission to Finance
- Approve purchase requests only for items within the approved budget and with valid business justification
- Ensure all team members complete mandatory financial compliance training annually
- Ensure accurate and timely timesheet submission across the team

Managers and Approvers

- Exercise judgement and due diligence before approving any financial document — approving a fraudulent or unjustified claim is a disciplinary matter regardless of intent
- Not approve their own expense claims — these must be escalated to the next approval level
- Respond to Finance approval requests within the stipulated timeframes to avoid payment delays

Annual Financial Compliance Training

All employees complete mandatory financial compliance training annually, covering: expense policy, procurement process, fraud awareness, data protection, and conflict of interest. Training is managed by HR in coordination with Finance. Completion is tracked and non-completions are reported to department heads. New joiners must complete the training within their first 30 days.

Section 35

Continuous Improvement

The Finance Department is committed to continuously improving its processes, tools, and capabilities. In a high-growth technology company, financial practices that are adequate today may be insufficient in 12 months. Continuous improvement is embedded in the department's operating rhythm.

Process Review Cycle

Every Finance process is reviewed on the following schedule:

Process Area	Review Frequency
This handbook (all policies)	Annually (April) or on material regulatory change
Approval authority matrix	Annually or on organisational change
Vendor management and procurement	Annually
Cloud cost governance	Quarterly
Software subscription utilisation	Semi-annually
Month-end close procedures	After each close cycle
Payroll procedures	Annually or on regulatory change
Tax compliance calendar	At start of each financial year

Finance Technology Upgrades

CoreAxis Technologies actively evaluates financial technology to improve efficiency and reduce manual processing. The Financial Analyst is responsible for tracking emerging finance technology trends and presenting proposals for

new tools or system upgrades to the Finance Manager. Any new financial system or significant upgrade to an existing system must follow the standard procurement and Information Security approval process before adoption.

Process Improvement Proposals

Any Finance team member may submit a process improvement proposal to the Finance Manager via a short written brief (one page maximum) covering: the current problem, the proposed change, expected benefit (time, cost, or risk reduction), and implementation effort. All proposals are reviewed within 30 days. Accepted proposals are added to the Finance Improvement Register in Confluence, assigned an owner, and tracked to completion.

Benchmarking

The Finance Manager participates in relevant professional forums (ICAI, CFA Institute events, CFO networking groups) and benchmarks CoreAxis Technologies' financial practices against industry peers at least annually. Insights from benchmarking are incorporated into the process review cycle and the continuous improvement agenda.

Finance Team Development

Each Finance team member has an individual development plan aligned to their role and career aspirations. The Finance Manager ensures that each team member completes at least 20 hours of relevant professional development per year. Finance supports team members pursuing professional qualifications (CA, CMA, CPA, CFA) with study leave and examination fee reimbursement subject to the Professional Development Policy.

Section 36

Appendix

A. Key Finance Contacts

Role	Email	Location
Finance Manager	finance.manager@coreaxis.in	Chennai
Accounts Payable	accounts-payable@coreaxis.in	Chennai
Accounts Receivable	accounts-receivable@coreaxis.in	Chennai
Payroll	payroll@coreaxis.in	Chennai
Procurement	procurement@coreaxis.in	Chennai

B. Key Forms and Templates

All forms referenced in this handbook are available in the Finance Department workspace on Confluence under the "Templates and Forms" section.

Employees must use the current version of each form. Forms downloaded and saved locally may be outdated — always download from Confluence before use.

Form Name	Purpose	Confluence Location
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Purchase Request Form	Initiate any purchase	Finance > Procurement > Forms
Expense Claim Form	Employee expense reimbursement	Finance > Expenses > Forms
Travel Request Form	Pre-approval for business travel	Finance > Travel > Forms
Vendor Onboarding Form	New vendor registration	Finance > Vendors > Forms
Asset Assignment Form	Record asset issued to employee	Finance > Assets > Forms
AI Training Cost Request	Pre-approval for GPU training runs > ₹1,00,000	Finance > Cloud > Forms
Corporate Card Reconciliation	Monthly card statement submission	Finance > Cards > Forms

C. Statutory Payment Calendar Summary

Obligation	Frequency	Due Date
TDS Deposit	Monthly	7th of the following month
GST Payment (GSTR-3B)	Monthly	20th of the following month
GSTR-1 Filing	Monthly	11th of the following month

PF Contribution	Monthly	15th of the following month
ESI Contribution	Monthly	15th of the following month
Advance Tax (Q1)	Annual	June 15
Advance Tax (Q2)	Annual	September 15
Advance Tax (Q3)	Annual	December 15
Advance Tax (Q4)	Annual	March 15
TDS Return (Q1: Apr–Jun)	Quarterly	July 31
TDS Return (Q2: Jul–Sep)	Quarterly	October 31
TDS Return (Q3: Oct–Dec)	Quarterly	January 31
TDS Return (Q4: Jan–Mar)	Quarterly	May 31
Income Tax Return (company)	Annual	October 31
GSTR-9 (Annual GST Return)	Annual	December 31
Statutory Audit Completion	Annual	July 31

D. Approval Authority Quick Reference

Amount	Approver
Up to ₹10,000	Department Head

₹10,001 – ₹25,000	Department Head + Finance Manager concurrence
₹25,001 – ₹1,00,000	Finance Manager
₹1,00,001 – ₹5,00,000	Finance Manager + CFO
Above ₹5,00,000	CFO + Board (where applicable)

E. Glossary

Term	Definition
C A P E X	Capital Expenditure — cost of assets with useful life > 1 year
O P E X	Operational Expenditure — recurring costs of running the business
P O	Purchase Order — formal commitment to purchase from a vendor
P R	Purchase Request — internal request to initiate a purchase
G R N	Goods Receipt Note — confirmation that goods have been received
F A R	Fixed Asset Register — record of all capitalised assets

T D S	Tax Deducted at Source — withholding tax under the Income Tax Act
G S T	Goods and Services Tax — indirect tax on supply of goods and services
G S TI N	GST Identification Number — company's GST registration number
P A N	Permanent Account Number — income tax identifier
P F	Provident Fund — statutory retirement savings contribution
E S I	Employee State Insurance — statutory health insurance scheme
S L A	Service Level Agreement — contractual service performance standards
N E F T	National Electronic Funds Transfer — electronic payment system
R T G S	Real Time Gross Settlement — high-value real-time payment
S a a S	Software as a Service — cloud-based software subscription model
R A G	Retrieval-Augmented Generation — AI system architecture

G P U	Graphics Processing Unit — compute hardware used for AI training
A P	Accounts Payable — outgoing payments to vendors
A R	Accounts Receivable — incoming payments from clients
In d A S	Indian Accounting Standards — financial reporting framework
I C A I	Institute of Chartered Accountants of India
R O C	Registrar of Companies — Ministry of Corporate Affairs authority
D S I R	Department of Scientific and Industrial Research

F. Document Control

Field	Value
Document Title	Finance Department Handbook
Document Owner	Finance Manager, CoreAxis Technologies
Version	1.0
Effective Date	01 April 2025
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Classificati on	Internal — Confidential
Distributio n	Finance Department; accessible to all employees on Confluence (read-only)
Approved By	CFO / CEO, CoreAxis Technologies